

MY GOOD BOY/GIRL

A Grief Journal for Dog Loss

By Daniel Tesfamariam

Because they were family.

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THEY WERE FAMILY

Your grief is real.

Your love was real.

The bond you shared was real.

You don't need anyone's permission to grieve.

They weren't 'just a dog.'

They were your companion, your comfort,
your family member, your best friend.

Take your time with this journal.

There is no timeline for grief.

MY DOG

Name: _____

Breed: _____

Birthday (or best guess): _____

Gotcha Day (when they came home): _____

Passed on: _____

Years together: _____

Color/markings: _____

Weight: _____

Favorite food: _____

Favorite toy: _____

Favorite spot: _____

Nicknames I called them: _____

Their signature move: _____

What made them unique: _____

The day we brought you home...

Your favorite spot in the house was...

You always made me laugh when...

The way you greeted me at the door...

Our morning routine together...

The funniest thing you ever did...

How you changed my life...

The little sounds you made...

What bedtime was like with you...

Your relationship with other people...

How you showed me love...

Things that remind me of you...

What you taught me about love...

THE RAINBOW BRIDGE

Just this side of heaven is a place
called Rainbow Bridge.

When an animal who has been especially
close to someone here passes,
they go to Rainbow Bridge.

There are meadows and hills for all
our special friends so they can run
and play together.

There is plenty of food, water, and sunshine,
and our friends are warm and comfortable.

All the animals who had been ill and old
are restored to health and vigor.

Then the day comes when one suddenly stops
and looks into the distance...

They have spotted you, and when you
and your special friend finally meet,
you cling together in joyous reunion,
never to be parted again.

**Grief is love
with nowhere to go.**

Your grief is proof
of how deeply you loved.

And that love still exists.

It always will.

CREATING A MEMORIAL

Ways to honor your dog’s memory:

- Plant a tree or garden in their name
- Create a photo album or shadow box
- Donate to a shelter in their honor
- Commission a portrait or custom artwork
- Keep their collar in a special place
- Write their story and share it
- Create a stepping stone for the garden
- Light a candle on their birthday
- Volunteer at an animal rescue
- Frame their paw print

How I want to honor my dog:

WHEN TO OPEN YOUR HEART AGAIN

There is no right timeline for getting another dog.

Some things to consider:

- A new dog will never replace your dog - they don't have to
- Getting another dog is not a betrayal
- Your dog would want you to love again
- Only you know when you're ready
- It's okay if that's soon. It's okay if that's years.
- It's also okay if the answer is never.

My feelings about another dog someday:

Forever yours, _____

**Until we meet again
at the Rainbow Bridge,**

know that you were the
very best dog.

You were loved beyond measure.

And you always will be.